

Request for Proposals (RFP)
TGF-17-127

**HEALTH SUPPLY CHAIN HUMAN RESOURCE CAPACITY ASSESSMENTS
AND EVALUATIONS**

Issue Date	24 th August 2017
Deadline for Questions	1 st September 2017
RFP Closing Date	8 th September 2017
RFP Closing Time	15:00 Geneva Time ⁽¹⁾
Estimated Start time	1 October, 2017
Proposal and Questions Submission Address	TGF Sourcing Application : https://access.theglobalfund.org/

⁽¹⁾ *Bidders intending to submit a proposal must be invited to the RFP and thus any request for a Supplier ID should be made at least 48 hours before the RFP closing date.*

1. The Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria (the “Global Fund”) now invites proposals for the above-captioned Project.
2. The Statement of Work for the Project is attached hereto as **Attachment A**.
3. The Global Fund will evaluate all proposals received in response to this Request for Proposals (RFP) in accordance with the Evaluation Criteria in **Attachment B**.
4. The requirements and general information regarding the RFP submission are attached hereto as **Attachment C**.
5. Terms and Conditions is attached hereto as **Attachment D**.
6. Conflict of interest form as **Attachment E**.
7. Country Technical experience as **Attachment F**
8. Pricing Matrix is enclosed as **Attachment G**
9. This RFP is in line with the Global Fund’s Procurement Regulations (2015, as amended from time to time), which may be found at <https://www.theglobalfund.org/en/business-opportunities/>. The following are integral parts of this RFP:
 - a. The Request for Proposal Solicitation Rules (2015, as amended from time to time), which may be found at: <https://www.theglobalfund.org/en/business-opportunities/>;

- b. The Policy on Ethics and Conflict of Interest for Global Fund Institutions (2002, as amended from time to time), which may be found at: <https://www.theglobalfund.org/en/policies-guidelines-templates/governance-policies/>;
- c. The Code of Conduct for Suppliers (2009, as amended from time to time), which may be found at: <https://www.theglobalfund.org/en/policies-guidelines-templates/governance-policies/>;
- d. The Sanctions Panel Procedures Relating to the Code of Conduct for Suppliers (2014, as amended from time to time), which may be found at <https://www.theglobalfund.org/en/policies-guidelines-templates/governance-policies/>; and
- e. The Global Fund Terms and Conditions of Purchase of Services (15 September 2015, as amended from time to time), which will also be an integral part of any contract resulting from this solicitation, and which may be found at <https://www.theglobalfund.org/en/business-opportunities/>.

Submitting a proposal in response to this RFP constitutes an acceptance of the terms indicated herein and of the terms of each of these documents, and the Global Fund reserves the right to reject the proposal of any entity or individual, as the case may be, that fails or refuses to comply with, or accept, such terms.

10. This RFP shall not be construed as a contract or a commitment of any kind. This RFP in no way obligates the Global Fund to award a contract, nor does it commit the Global Fund to pay any costs or expenses incurred in the preparation or submission of proposals.

TGF Sourcing Application

1. For audit and efficiency purposes, this RFP process is being managed electronically, and bidders are required to submit their proposals in the following URL for Sourcing Application: <https://access.theglobalfund.org/>.
2. Please use the attached Guidance Notes – ***“SUPPLIER INSTRUCTION – How to respond to a Request For Quotation(RFQ’s)***
3. Proposals must be submitted in TGF Sourcing Application, and received by the Global Fund by the RFP Closing Time and at the RFP Closing Date, all as indicated in the above RFP Information Table.
4. In case, you do not have a Supplier ID in TGF Sourcing Application, please send an email to **fabienne.valance@theglobalfund.org** with the following title in the subject:
 - TGF-17-125- Request for login user id creation in TGF Sourcing /iSupplier portal – “Put your organization name”.
5. Unless otherwise indicated, proposals shall be divided in two separate folders, one containing your cost proposal and one containing your technical proposal.

The subject line of your attachment must be labelled as follows:

- TGF-17-127- Your organization name – technical proposal
- TGF-17-127- Your organization name – cost proposal

When relevant, Conflict of Interest declaration form should also be returned.

6. All communications with regard to this RFP shall be in writing and sent through the TGF Sourcing Application platform using the online discussion as indicated in the above RFP Information Table.
7. Any communication between a Bidder and the Global Fund regarding this RFP, which is not through the designated channel (<https://access.theglobalfund.org/>), shall invalidate such Bidder's proposal to this RFP

ATTACHMENT A TERMS OF REFERENCE

1. BACKGROUND INFORMATION

The Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria (“the Global Fund”) was established in January 2002 as a financial instrument, complementary to existing programs addressing HIV/AIDS, tuberculosis and malaria. The purpose of the Global Fund is to attract, manage and disburse additional resources through a new public-private partnership that will make a sustainable and significant contribution to the reduction of infections, illness and death, thereby mitigating the impact caused by HIV/AIDS, tuberculosis and malaria in countries in need, and contributing to poverty reduction as part of the Millennium Development Goals.

The Global Fund bases its work on programs that reflect national ownership and respect country partnership-led formulation and implementation processes. The Global Fund promotes partnerships among all relevant players within the country and across all sectors of society. It builds on existing coordination mechanisms, and promotes new and innovative partnerships. In addition, the Global Fund strengthens and reflects high-level, sustainable political involvement and commitment in making allocations of its resources.

The Global Fund supports existing and new innovative programs both within and outside the health sector that promote public, private and nongovernmental efforts for scaling up the prevention, treatment, care and support to those that are directly affected.

Programs supported by the Global Fund, as of July 2016, have 10 million people on antiretroviral therapy for AIDS, have tested and treated 16.6 million people for TB, and have distributed 626 million insecticide-treated nets to protect families against malaria.

The Global Fund is a non-profit foundation with headquarters in Geneva, Switzerland. The Fund is accountable to its Board, the highest decision making body, which consists of representatives of donors, recipient countries, civil society, the private sector and non-governmental organizations as well as other stakeholders from a broad range of interest groups and communities, including multi-lateral organizations.

The Global Fund's Secretariat is responsible for day-to-day operations, including mobilizing resources from the public and private sectors, managing grants, providing financial, legal and administrative support, and reporting information on the Global Fund's activities to the Board and the public.

Procurement and Supply Chain Capacity Building Program

Access to essential medicines is critical to reaching universal health coverage and is recognized as a key building block of a strong health system. Medicines and health products are important for addressing health problems and improving quality of lives. They form an indispensable component of health systems in the prevention, diagnosis and treatment of disease and in alleviating disability and functional deficiency.

Supply chain management (SCM) is critically important to the Global Fund achieving its mission and contributing to building Resilient and Sustainable Systems for Health (RSSH). Ineffective supply chains weaken the overall health system's ability to respond to the healthcare needs of the population, put treatment programs at risk and remain a significant barrier to access to essential health products.

The Global Fund is a major donor in the health sector and has an important role to play in contributing to strengthen in-country supply chain. Health products represent the greatest category of Global Fund grant spending to curb the epidemics, and this percentage has been rising under the New Funding Model. The Global Fund will provide more than USD 10 billion over 2014-2017 with approximately 50% of this being for the procurement of health products and supply chain management.

Effective and sustainable supply chain systems, as a key component of resilient and sustainable systems for health, are central to achieving the core mission of the Global Fund. Countries require financial and technical support to develop or strengthen their capacities to perform the various disciplines of the supply chain systems. The Global Fund has been funding the strengthening of health product management and supply chains since its inception on the basis of country requests or as part of risk mitigation measures to protect its investments; it has thus contributed to capacity building and health-system strengthening efforts. To date, investments have tended to be piecemeal and primarily made in government owned and operated systems e.g. trucks bought, warehouses racked, LMIS implemented. As a result supply failure has been prevented and lives have been saved; however improvements have been tenuous and short lived, and sustainable systems have yet to be built

Supply chain represents the most prevalent risk in the Global Fund's portfolio. In a risk assessment of grants since May 2015:

- 41% ranked Treatment Disruption as a High Risk
- 23% ranked Theft or Diversion of Non-Financial Assets as a High Risk
- 9% ranked Substandard Quality of Health Products as a High Risk

Specific supply chain challenges that reduce access and overall health impact observed through reviews and assessments within countries include:

- Stock-outs of essential supplies in a number of health facilities and points in the supply chain; whilst expired drugs are noted at other points;
- Some warehouses and distribution facilities not meeting minimum standards for storing and transporting health products;
- Poor visibility, unavailability of consumption data and lack of integrated data management systems
- Lack of basic logistics management control/information systems; and
- Inefficiencies due to poor coordination, integration and harmonization, with duplication of some supply chain activities resulting from well-intentioned "parallel" supply chains created to address the immediate needs for access to health care products.

Current supply chain weaknesses and traditional models coupled with increasing demand, thus represent a risk to both the investment and the expected outcomes.

Given the critical importance of the strength of in-country supply chains to public health, the Global Fund is exploring how it can best increase its focus on supporting in-country supply chain work.

As part of this increased focus the GF has launched a number of activities including some initial in-country transformational programs, development of guiding principles for in-country supply chain investments and an external "thematic review" that considered the Fund's role and required resources for strengthening in-country supply chain systems.

The current country interventions followed a preliminary segmentation of countries in the portfolio considering level of investment, risk and ability to achieve transformation. However the ability to make fact-based decisions was hampered by the fact that currently the Global Fund's data around supply chain is not consolidated in one place and has gaps on key information. The ability to undertake such transformational change has been limited by the organizational capacity and structures, and the fact that data is still not available within the Global Fund to systematically assess the impact of the investments in supply chain strengthening.

The Thematic Review identified that among partner, donor and key opinion leader interviewees, there was a very strong and broadly based feeling that the Global Fund must take the leadership role in Supply Chain Strengthening

“GF must recognise that it is in the SC strengthening game”

“It is becoming vital that the Global Fund steps forward into a Supply Chain leadership role at country level as it has at the global level”

The review confirmed the Global Fund should tailor its role to a differentiated portfolio of countries, and that the Global Fund needed to establish revised organizational and financial structure to enable it to take a lead role in supply chain strengthening.

Consequent to this review, the Fund formed an internal Supply Chain Task Force to provide governance for the required reforms and designed a new supply chain organization. This organization identified a number of new roles and functions, in addition to reallocation of resources currently supporting supply chain/ health product management in line with the GF's differentiation priorities. The roles within the organization will provide specialist expertise to support initiatives across the portfolio and capacity to support targeted transformational changes.

The critical recommendation was the appointment of a highly experienced professional to provide high-profile leadership to the new department and drive the required improvements.

Against this background and to mitigate and manage the inherent risks and identified challenges, the Global Fund needs a clear strategy and operational plan for how it will work with countries to achieve transformations in supply chain. In order to do this there is a need to consolidate the various information into a coherent structured information base; identify gaps and potential strategic approaches and solutions; confirm the Global Fund's vision and role with respect to supply chain; and develop an endorsed, costed structured and evidence-based strategy to achieve this; underpinned by a realistic phased plan and set of initiatives.

2. OBJECTIVES

- 2.1 The objectives of this Request for Proposal (RFP) is to pre-qualify suppliers(s) who are knowledgeable about the common challenges and solutions within human resource capacity in health supply chains, and are able to lead, coordinate and organize a people baseline assessment and evaluation in country, and can manage large internal and external team members within prescribed timelines and budgets.
- 2.2 The Global Fund wishes to enter into indefinite quantity contracts (IQC) with pre-qualified suppliers that can provide consultancy services for human resource capacity assessments and evaluations in health supply chain management for a period of initially one (1) year, and will

be subject to renewal under the same terms and conditions based on satisfactory performance for an additional term of two (2) years. The selected suppliers should be able to deliver services in at least one or more of the 123 Global Fund countries.

3. SCOPE OF SERVICE

The scope of the contract is to work with the Global Fund to provide the following expertise:

3.1 Analyze a country's HR capacity to manage the health procurement and supply chain and recommend actions for capacity building efforts

- a) Use and adapt the assessment tool "Human Resource Capacity Development in Public Health Supply Chain Management: Assessment Guide and Tool" to gauge how well a human resource system functions and its contribution to overall supply chain performance
- b) Collaborate with in country staff, Global Fund and other partners to scope the focus point of the actual assessment
- c) Build a process which includes four phases: scope, build, collect, and analyze
- d) Report findings and recommendations, and build an action plan, in collaboration with country staff, Global Fund and other partners, for strengthening the human resource development and management capacity within a specific supply chain context

3.2 Evaluate and measure performance of capacity building efforts

- a) Use a "Theory of Change" as the M&E framework and refine the assessment tool.
- b) Evaluate and measure sustainable improvement in capacity in identified country.
- c) Publish and share results with TGF members and partners.

4. REQUIREMENTS / DESCRIPTION OF ASSIGNMENT

The chosen supplier will offer technical support:

- a) Project scoping/requirements definition and baseline assessment subject to complexity or need of the country, with in country staff, Global Fund and other partners
- b) Manage large internal and external team members within prescribed timelines and budgets
- c) Provide a library of proven strategies for addressing current and future capacity building needs/efforts
- d) Assist partners and/or work to develop prioritized and recommended actions to improve the HR capacity based on evidence generated from the country context
- e) Thorough evaluation of capacity building efforts

4.1. ANALYZE A COUNTRY'S HR CAPACITY TO MANAGE THE HEALTH SUPPLY CHAIN AND RECOMMEND ACTIONS FOR CAPACITY BUILDING EFFORTS

Though other approaches will be considered, it is assumed that the following general tasks will be part of the assessment.

- a) Use and adapt the assessment tool "Human Resource Capacity Development in Public Health Supply Chain Management: Assessment Guide and Tool" to the identified country and supply chain in order to gauge how well a human resource system functions and its contribution to overall supply chain performance.
- b) Build a process which includes four phases: scope, build, collect, and analyze

- a. **Scope assessment:**
 - Build a clear and feasible scope of work, agreed upon by both the client and the assessment team. Include: purpose of assessment, HRH building blocks to be assessed, levels of the supply chain to be assessed, and timeframe
 - Build the assessment team, engage key stakeholders, compile reference documents, and develop health supply chain profile
- b. **Build assessment process and tool:**
 - Conduct assessment team training workshop
 - Build data collection tool, plan and methodologies
- c. **Collect data:**
 - Conduct launch workshop to inform and solicit the support and participation of in-country stakeholders
 - Collect data from identified informants using the data collection tool, as adapted by the assessment team, and in adherence with the data collection plan.
 - Conduct interviews and focus groups with stakeholders
 - Conduct preliminary data review to examine initial data
- d. **Analyze data:**
 - After the data collection process is complete, the assessment team reviews, consolidates, and analyzes the data
 - Findings should be validated against and supported by the information contained in the secondary data sources
 - Conduct root cause analysis
 - Re-interview stakeholders
- c) Report findings and recommendations, and build an action plan for strengthening the human resource development and management capacity within a specific supply chain context
 - a. Validate findings and recommendations through a validation workshop in country with key stakeholders
 - b. Develop a strategic action plan
 - c. Obtain government buy-in
 - d. Identify stakeholders and obtain commitment to action

4.2 EVALUATE AND MEASURE PERFORMANCE OF CAPACITY BUILDING EFFORTS

- a) Refine the assessment tool “Human Resource Capacity Development in Public Health Supply Chain Management: Assessment Guide and Tool” to include PtD’s Theory of Change as the M&E framework
- b) Evaluate and measure sustainable improvement in capacity in the identified country

5. REPORTING AND LANGUAGE REQUIREMENTS

In general, for each ToR and assignment, reports shall be required in English; however, there may be countries that require the report and other support to be provided in an additional language i.e. French and Portuguese.

For each request, the language requirement(s) shall be clearly stated.

6. LOCATION AND DURATION

As defined by the ToR and assignment, the work will involve travel to an identified country and will also involve remote work for preparation and report writing. After the IQC agreement has been signed, the location of each assignment and reporting requirements will be defined in each ToR.

We expect the selected vendor, before deployment into Country, will spend one day in Geneva for a Country specific briefing meeting. The cost of this meeting (max 2 representatives) should be included in the proposal.

7. SUPPLIER QUALIFICATION REQUIREMENTS

The selected Supplier shall demonstrate a proven experience in leading, coordinating and organizing baseline HR for SCM assessments and evaluations, and demonstrate knowledge about the common challenges and solutions within human resource capacity in health supply chains.

8. TECHNICAL DIRECTIONS

Technical directions for this assignment will come from the Head of the Supply Chain department or his/her delegate and the Health Product Management Specialist of the Country Team.

9. COUNTRIES TO BE ASSESSED

The following countries are in the scope of this RFP. However, bidder should note that this list is provided for reference only, and may be subject to change, with some countries added or removed.

1. Angola
2. Benin
3. Cambodia
4. Cote d'Ivoire
5. Ethiopia
6. Gambia
7. Guyana
8. India
9. Indonesia
10. Lesotho
11. Malawi
12. Mozambique
13. Pakistan
14. Salvador
15. Senegal
16. South Sudan
17. Tanzania
18. Zambia
19. Zimbabwe

ATTACHMENT B. EVALUATION CRITERIA

The Global Fund Technical Evaluation Committee (TEC) will assess the extent to which proposals submitted in response to this RFP meet the evaluation criteria below and in accordance with the Global Fund Solicitation Rules.

In assessing each proposal, the Global Fund will allocate greater importance to technical factors than to cost factors **(80% weighting for technical factors and 20% weighting for cost factors)**.

A two stage procedure will be utilized in evaluating the proposals, with evaluation of the technical proposal being completed prior to any price proposal being considered; and cost evaluation is only undertaken for technical submissions that at minimum of **70 points out of 100**. A proposal which fails to achieve the minimum technical threshold may not be considered further.

A. Technical Proposal

Technical proposals will be evaluated based on the following evaluation criteria:

Criteria	Requirement	%
1) Overall response	• Completeness of response and Overall concord between requirements and proposal • Quality and completeness of proposed work plan to achieve the goals stated in the RFP	10
2) Expertise, Experience of Company and Key Personnel	• Project expertise in leading, coordinating and organizing baseline HR for SCM assessments and evaluation • Project experience in Global Fund relevant countries • Capacity to provide sufficient team members for the scale and scope of work required • Recommendations from current client list, preferably from similar operations	65
3) Proposed methodology and approach	• Methodology align with the Global Fund supply chain vision of work • The extent to which the supplier's proposal highlights adequate understanding of tasks and deliverables as well as the strength of proposed technical approach and methodology • Supplier quality assurance and risk mitigations mechanisms	25

B. Cost Proposal

Proposals will be evaluated in terms of best value to the Global Fund, price and other factors considered.

ATTACHMENT C
PROPOSAL REQUIREMENTS & GENERAL INFORMATION

I. PROPOSAL REQUIREMENTS

The proposal should be concisely presented and structured, and should explain in detail your availability, ability, capacity and resources to provide the requested services. Proposals that are incomplete or not responsive to these criteria may not be considered in the review process. All proposals must be submitted in English.

Both the technical and cost proposals should clearly articulate any assumptions and resource requirements required from the Global Fund

Cost proposal and technical proposal must be send separately, as two separate documents:

a. Technical Proposal

The proposal shall demonstrate the provider's technical and organizational capacity (i.e. organization structure, experience, resources, staff and overall facilities including subcontractors) in the areas defined under the requirements section.

Include:

1. A brief overview of your organization ((e.g. organizational structure, number of staff, financial management, various areas of expertise, etc.). Include an overview of a consortium or sub-partners being proposed;
2. Information on past experience in work/project that is similar in nature and volume to the services requested (brief description, date, client etc.).
3. Approach not exceeding 10 pages describing:
 - a. A brief description of the supplier's approach to each of the tasks listed in the RFP;
 - b. A brief overview as to how the supplier would propose to manage the delivery of high quality and timely services for the countries; and
 - c. A summary of the supplier experience and/or language and other relevant skills in different regions/countries, alongside preference in terms of countries for implementation.
 - d. Roles for each of the proposed expert, level of involvement and their resume as annex to the technical proposal.
4. Completed Attachment F
5. Composition and qualifications of the proposed teams are key to successful selection of the supplier at the time of country specific competition and implementation of the services on the ground.
 - a. The supplier is invited to explain in the proposal how access to qualified staff will be ensured on a short notice for country specific assignments;
 - b. CVs, roles and organigram of the central management team must be included in this section (as per template provided in Annex 1).

Sample team composition

Provide details of the team leader for each country, and specify who additional team members will be allocated as needed. For instance:

1. Team Leader
2. Specify as needed
3. Specify as needed
4. Specify as needed

6. three (3) references and contacts where related assignment was implemented

b. Cost Proposal:

Proposals will be evaluated in terms of best value to the Global Fund, price and other factors considered. Cost proposals must be submitted in USD and be fully inclusive.

The cost proposal should be based on a standard rate card which will form the basis of the pricing for the long term agreement. However it should be noted that future engagements may be negotiated based on a time and material or fixed price basis.

Please use Attachment G to submit your cost proposal / rate card. Note that two tabs have to be completed:

1. Proposed rate card
2. Sample country proposal

II. PROPOSAL SUBMISSION AND COMMUNICATIONS

Proposal submissions and all communication should be sent through the RFP platform.

The full proposal must be submitted no later than **the date and time indicated on page 1 of this RFP**. Prior to submission, remember to allowing sufficient time for the creation of a Supplier ID.

Please submit three separate attachments labelled as follows:

- TGF-17-127 - Your organization name – technical proposal
- TGF-17-127- Your organization name – cost proposal
- TGF-17-127- Your organization name – conflict of interest

III. SPECIFIC INSTRUCTIONS

a. Period of validity

Proposals should be valid for a period of 6 calendar months from the closing date of their receipt.

b. Modifications to Proposal

No further additions to, or modifications on submitted proposals shall be allowed unless it is proven to be a bona fide typographical error or omission and that it may have material impact on the evaluation process. Such additions or modifications may only be effected with prior, written, approval from The Global Fund.

c. Tender expenses

Suppliers are solely responsible for their own expenses or losses, if any, in preparing and submitting an offer to this Request for Proposal. This would include any costs incurred during functional demonstrations and subsequent meetings and negotiations.

d. Currency and language to be used

All costs in the pricing spreadsheets must be in United States Dollars USD only. The currency of the contract will be in USD. All communication in respect to this RFP shall be in English.

IV. GENERAL INFORMATION

The Global Fund may, at its discretion, change the closing date, cancel the RFP, or revise the terms of reference, by issuing an amendment to this solicitation. All amendments to this RFP will be also posted on the Global Fund website: <https://www.theglobalfund.org/en/business-opportunities/>

It is the Supplier's responsibility to consult the Global Fund's website to ensure that they are aware of amendments to this RFP.

The Global Fund may (a) reject any or all proposals, (b) accept for award a proposal other than the lowest cost proposal, (c) accept more than one proposal, (d) accept alternate proposals, (e) accept part of a proposal, (f) waive informalities and minor irregularities in proposals received, and (g) cancel this RFP.

The Global Fund may award one or more contracts on the basis of initial proposals received, without discussions or negotiations. Therefore, each initial proposal should contain the Supplier's best terms from a cost and technical standpoint. The Global Fund reserves the right (but is not under obligation to do so) to enter into discussions with one or more Suppliers in order to obtain clarifications or additional detail, to suggest refinements in the technical proposal or other aspects of the proposal, or negotiate the cost proposal.

The Global Fund will be under no obligation to reveal, or discuss with any Suppliers, how a proposal was assessed, or to provide any other information relative to the selection process. Suppliers whose proposals are not selected will be notified in writing of this fact, and shall have no claim whatsoever for any kind of compensation.

This RFP shall not be construed as a contract or a commitment of any kind. This request for proposals in no way obligates the Global Fund to award a contract, nor does it commit the Global Fund to pay any cost incurred in the preparation of the proposal.

In addition to the written proposal, the Global Fund may request bidders to make oral presentations in English or to participate in a pre-proposal conference. The date, time, and place for such (if any) will be communicated to all eligible bidders. Any statement or presentation made during these meetings shall not in any way amend or modify the Global Fund RFP Invitation Notice solicitation.

Information obtained through oral presentations will be considered in the overall evaluation process.